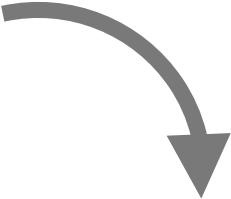


then it is a
necessary truth
that there are
contingent things

but then premise
(1) of the original
argument is false







then, by the PSR,
there must be some
explanation of
God's bringing
about the existence
of contingent
things

but what could this
be?







God brings about
the existence of
contingent things

A large, solid orange circle serves as the background for the text.

contingent



necessary



Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR



objections
to the
PSR



exp1anation of

about the existence



God's birthing ing



off content

the first time

things

then, by the PSR,

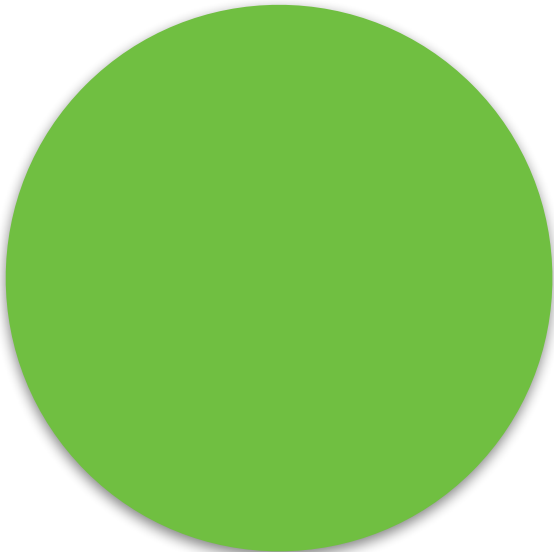


but what would this

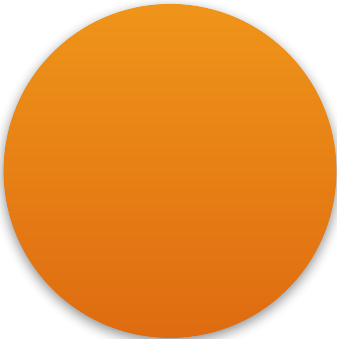
de

e

?







... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

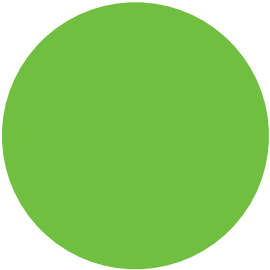
Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

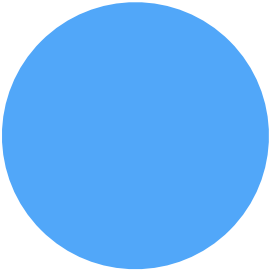
What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.





the
PSR







Last time we considered an objection to Aquinas' assumption that if a first

be Good.

simply be some event, like the Big Bang, which is not a plausible candidate to

cause exists, then God exists: the objection was that the first cause could

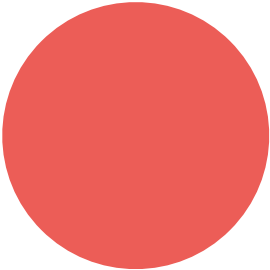


Leibniz's
argument





Leibniz's
argument





objections
to the
PSR

might think, for example, that we

things.

contingent things in terms of God's

can explain God's creation of

The right hand side of the diagram

might not look too bad at first. We

deciding to create contingent

then, by the PSR,
there must be some
explanation of
God's bringing
about the existence
of contingent
things

but what could this
be?

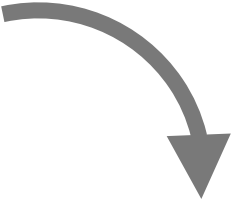


A large, solid green circle is centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "God brings about the existence of contingent things" is written in a white, serif font, arranged in four lines.

God brings about
the existence of
contingent things

A large, solid orange circle serves as the background for the text.

contingent



then, by the PSR,
there must be some
explanation of
God's bringing
about the existence
of contingent
things

but what could this
be?





A large, solid green circle is centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "God brings about the existence of contingent things" is written in a white, serif font, arranged in three lines.

God brings about
the existence of
contingent things

A large, solid orange circle serves as the background for the text.

contingent